

Leave, Vacation, and Time-Off Policy

Document owner	People Operations
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Review cycle	Annual or after material regulatory/process change
Audience	All employees, contractors, and people managers

Purpose and Scope

This policy defines how employees request, approve, record, and use paid time off, sick leave, parental leave, bereavement leave, public holidays, and unpaid leave. It applies to full-time and part-time employees unless a local employment contract or law provides a greater benefit.

Managers are responsible for planning team coverage fairly and approving requests consistently. Employees are responsible for submitting requests early, documenting urgent absences, and keeping calendars current.

Annual Vacation Entitlement

Full-time employees receive 20 working days of paid vacation per calendar year, accrued monthly. Employees with five or more years of service receive 25 working days. Part-time employees accrue vacation on a pro-rated basis.

Unused vacation may carry over up to five days into the next calendar year and must be used by March 31. Carryover above five days requires written approval from People Operations due to business-critical constraints or documented leave interruption.

Employee group	Annual vacation	Carryover rule
Full-time, under 5 years	20 working days	Up to 5 days until March 31
Full-time, 5+ years	25 working days	Up to 5 days until March 31
Part-time	Pro-rated by scheduled hours	Same pro-rated carryover principle

Request and Approval Process

Vacation requests of one to five days should be submitted at least ten business days in advance. Requests longer than five consecutive working days should be submitted at least thirty calendar days in advance.

Managers should approve or decline requests within three business days. Declines must include a business reason and an alternative time window when possible. Employees should not book non-refundable travel before approval is recorded in the HR system.

Sick Leave and Medical Absence

Employees may use paid sick leave when they are unable to work due to illness, injury, medical appointments, or care for an immediate family member. Employees should notify their manager before the start of the workday when practical.

A medical certificate may be requested after three consecutive working days of absence or where required by local regulation. Managers must not ask for diagnosis details; only fitness-for-work and expected return date may be requested.

Parental, Caregiver, and Bereavement Leave

Eligible employees may request parental leave according to local law and company benefit plans. People Operations coordinates documentation, payroll treatment, and return-to-work planning.

Employees receive up to five paid working days for bereavement involving an immediate family member and up to two paid working days for extended family. Additional unpaid leave may be approved for travel, estate duties, or cultural observances.

Holiday Scheduling and Coverage

Company holidays are published annually by region. Teams supporting customer-facing operations must maintain minimum coverage plans for peak periods and public holidays.

Where multiple employees request the same high-demand period, managers should consider business criticality, prior holiday allocation, dependency coverage, and fairness across the team.

Compliance and Records

All leave must be recorded in the HR system by the employee or manager. Off-system approvals in chat or email should be transferred into the HR system before payroll close.

Retaliation for lawful leave use is prohibited. Questions about eligibility, medical privacy, or local statutory rights should be escalated to People Operations.